After I got home, two members of my campaign team found me there and convinced me to return to the meeting. I cooled down and was back at the auditorium before the meeting had ended; I got back on the platform and tried to explain how I had been raised and why I took such offense at Christopher's remarks. I think they understood why I had exploded in response to the attack on my integrity. But it was the last time I stalked off a stage during a political debate. That day, I suppose, was all part of my political education.

The personal attacks against me during the primary finally became so heavy that the state Republican chairman, Gaylord Parkinson, postulated what he called the Eleventh Commandment: *Thou shalt not speak ill of any fellow Republican*. It's a rule I followed during that campaign and have ever since.

After beating Christopher in the primary, I had to deal with Brown, whose campaign against me, simply put, asked a question: What is an actor doing seeking an important job like the governorship of California?

As the campaign got under way, Brown seemed confident he'd win his third term in a breeze. He had previously beaten not only Dick Nixon, a former vice-president of the United States, but U.S. Senator William F. Knowland, an Oakland publisher who was another Republican powerhouse in California, and I suspect he thought it would be even easier to knock off this newcomer to politics from Hollywood.

I intended to focus my campaign on issues, but couldn't ignore Brown's attacks that I was unqualified for the job because I was an actor inexperienced as an elected politician. I decided to turn this around and present myself as what I was: an ordinary citizen who wanted to start unraveling the mess politicians were making of our government.